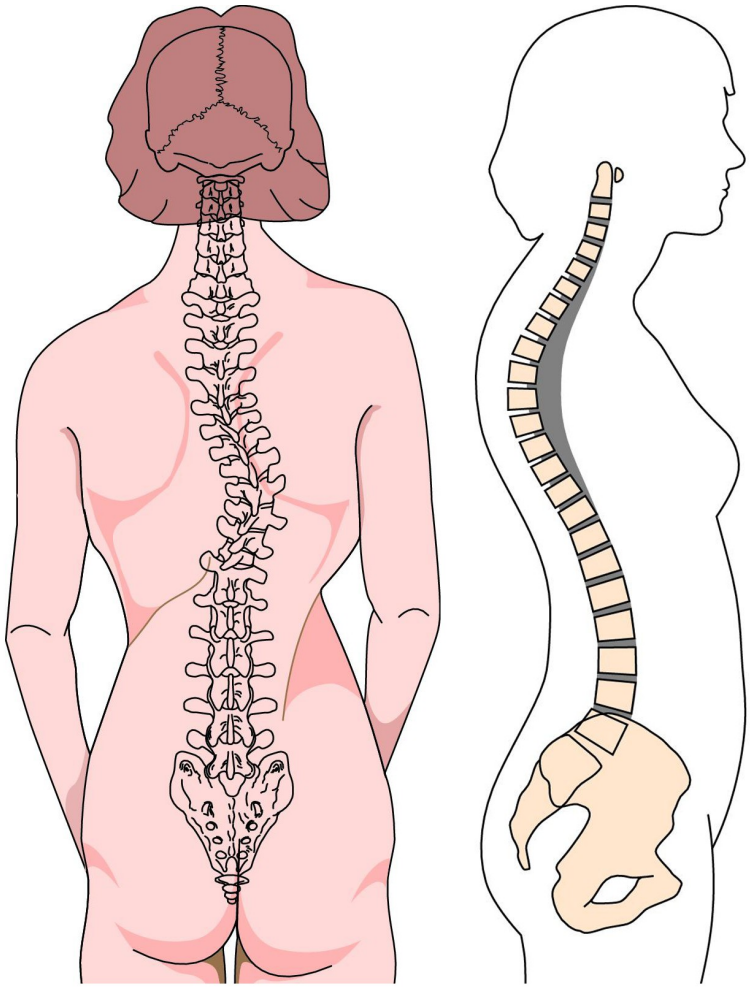
Kyphoscoliosis is characterized by anterior flexion of the spine (kyphosis) and lateral curvature of the spine (scoliosis). Idiopathic scoliosis accounts for 80% of cases although it may also be associated with neuromuscular conditions such as polio, cerebral palsy, and muscular dystrophy. It affects females four times as often as males.

Most significantly, curvature of greater than 40 degrees is considered to be severe and is associated with restrictive lung disease, pulmonary hypertension, and eventually cor pulmonale.

As the degree of curvature worsens, lung tissue is compressed and vital capacity decreases. The increased airway resistance and distorted anatomy increase the work of breathing, resulting in an increased alveolar-arterial oxygen difference. The $PaCO_2$ is typically normal unless some other insult such as infection occurs.



Hines RL, Marschall KE. Stoeltings Anesthesia & Co-Existing Diseases. 6th ed. New York, NY: Churchill-Livingston; 2012: 452-453.

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